A Seat for a Sea Tale

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 1

Four requests lay beside four books on the new Storyboat. The original ferry still had its own job elsewhere. This boat would bring library loans to Commons, Reed Creek, Farm Quay, and Mill Pond. Nib placed a splendid spare seat directly across the deck walkway. Lark stopped with the first book in her wings.

“A magnificent seat,” Nib announced. “A magnificent place to walk past it,” Lark suggested gently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **my**

“In sea and seat, ea writes long e,” Lark modeled clearly. “It can sound like ee in see. Read sea, then add the ending sound for seat. We learn this spelling from these examples; other ea words may need different help.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try sea, seat, team. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read seat on the deck plan,” Lark invited gently. “Which supported place leaves the walkway clear?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **A team can see a seat. A seat is on a mat.**

“Who can see a seat?” Lark asked gently. “Where does the second sentence put it?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib moved the seat onto its marked supports. Lark packed Sea in the first dry compartment for Commons. Three other requested books went into separate compartments, their titles supplied aloud. The deck route stayed open. The lending record began with four requests and no loans yet completed.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write seat beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your first boat journal page showed a clear walkway. Before leaving, the crew needed to fit the dry chest's lid so it could open without striking the newly placed seat.